SHAHRAM AJLOO

Production Supervisor · Medical devices, clean room and the shift that delivers

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Convatec · Infusion Care, Osted · Production Supervisor, day shift

Application: Production Supervisor, Convatec

To the Production Manager and the hiring team at Convatec, Osted

An infusion set is a small device with an unusually direct line to a person. Somebody connects it in the morning, trusts it for a day, and never thinks about the shift that produced it. That trust is decided in the clean room, a thousand times per shift, at the machine and at the documentation — and the supervisor is the person who makes the right decision the easy one and the shortcut the difficult one. That is the job I want, and it is the job I have been doing in different regulated settings for twenty years.

I would run the shift as team leader for the operators and coordinators on four fixed things. First, **the shift starts before the shift**: the staffing model checked against the production plan, resources and quality demands matched to the production targets, absence and holidays known early, vacation planning done months ahead with the resource coordinators instead of in the week it hurts. Second, **training is the flexibility you actually have**: a live cross-training matrix per machine and process group, so sickness, summer and overtime never depend on one person, and competence is signed off rather than assumed. Third, **the numbers are honest and visible**: output against plan, the three components an OEE is built from — availability, performance, quality — plus absence and deviations, on a board the shift can read at handover, not in a report a month later. Fourth, **GMP, GDP and 5S are the job, not an audit**: records written in the room while the work happens, deviations raised on the shift they occur, CAPA closed at the point of cause, and a 5S standard that is visible the moment you walk in.

Regulated production is my home ground. At **Novo Nordisk** in Kalundborg and Bagsværd I worked inside a **GMP/FDA/EMA** system for nearly two years: SOPs, change control, deviations, **CAPA**, root cause analysis, qualification to IQ/OQ/PQ and FAT/SAT — and I delivered **37 parallel capital projects** with 25 specialists through audited handover with **zero critical findings**. I have worked inside GMP production buildings where gowning, airlocks and controlled areas are part of an ordinary working day, and where a record that is written afterwards is worth nothing.

The people side is not a theory for me either. Since 2023 I have run **ELOHVAC** with full P&L and **five electricians and three apprentices**: recruitment, one-to-one and appraisal conversations, training plans, absence follow-up, overtime approval, budgets, and the conversations nobody enjoys. Before that I led **14 employees and 11 concurrent projects** at **Ventek-Air** with daily board meetings and capacity planning, and **12 technicians** at **ARJ Engineering** in a machine workshop where shift planning, training and output targets were the daily measurement. Skilled-trade teams tell you quickly whether a leader is present; mine have stayed, and the apprentices I trained are still in the trade.

Standards and improvement I have practised where they cost something. For five years I was operations and maintenance manager at **Lynetten under Biofos**, a critical plant in 24/7 shift operation: 5S, standard work and PDCA on the workshop and the stores, safety discipline with LOTO and APV, and KPI follow-up on availability, breakdowns and response times. Energy management on metering and SCADA data delivered **more than 40 % lower consumption**, documented — which is what continuous improvement looks like when it is finished rather than started. In my own company I build the measurement tools myself in Python and Claude, and the same habit applies on a shift: the number on the board is the number we act on, not the one that makes the month look good.

Convatec makes single-use devices for people managing a chronic condition, and the Osted site has just been expanded with new cleanroom capacity and a new machine park. Growth like that puts pressure exactly where a supervisor stands: new equipment, new operators, more documentation, same quality standard. Your values — **improve care, deliver results, grow together, own it, do what's right** — describe the leader a shift in a controlled environment needs, and **forever caring** is a promise that is kept or broken at the machine, by the operator, on my shift.

Practically: I live in Måløv, Osted is about forty-five minutes by car, and I work the day shift without drama — **driver's licence (B)**, fluent **Danish and English**, and I can start by agreement. I would like to hear where the shift stands on cross-training and absence today, and which machine group is the hardest to staff in a holiday week — that is where I would start.

Kind regards,

Shahram Ajloo

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PROFILE

Production and operations leader with 20+ years in regulated manufacturing, capital projects and 24/7 shift operation — authorised machine and electrical installer (LV/MV/HV) and B.Tech degree in Technology Management & Mechanical Engineering. Nearly two years inside a GMP/FDA/EMA system at Novo Nordisk with SOPs, deviations, CAPA, change control and qualification, and 37 capital projects handed over with zero critical findings. Led 5 to 14 people with full P&L: recruitment, one-to-ones, training plans, absence follow-up and staffing against a model. Lean practice in 5S, standard work and PDCA, with KPI and OEE logic on a board the shift can read.

PRODUCTION, PEOPLE AND QUALITY

- **Shift leadership and daily operations:** Daily board meetings with output against plan, machine status, quality issues and staffing for the next shift; priorities set with the production manager and resource coordinator, the handover written so the next shift starts informed, and the process streamlined wherever it costs a step.
- **Staffing, absence and training:** Staffing against an agreed model, absence and absenteeism followed up individually and early, overtime approved with a reason, vacations planned months ahead against the production plan; and a competence matrix per machine group showing who is signed off, who is in training and who is the only person who can run a line.
- **People management:** Recruitment, 1-1 meetings and appraisal conversations, employee development agreed with the production manager, and the difficult conversations held early and fairly — disciplinary actions handled by procedure, not by mood.
- **GMP, GDP and quality systems:** Records completed in the room as the work happens, deviations raised on the shift, NC and CAPA taken to root cause and closed at the point of cause; audit-ready documentation from 37 projects with zero critical findings in a GMP/FDA/EMA system, written as if the accreditation body were already in the room.
- **Continuous improvement and 5S:** 5S, standard work, PDCA, A3 and value stream mapping used as daily practice, not as a campaign; improvement ideas raised by the shift and taken forward with production management and support functions until they are standard.

TOOLS AND METHODS

Task	Tool and documented use
KPI and OEE	Output against plan, availability, performance and quality from production, SCADA and asset data; absence, deviations and rework on the same board, followed weekly.
Quality system	SOPs, change control, deviations, NC and CAPA, root cause analysis (5-why, Ishikawa, A3); qualification to IQ/OQ/PQ and acceptance through FAT/SAT in a GMP/FDA/EMA environment.
Lean	5S and visual management, standard work, PDCA, value stream mapping and Kaizen; continuous improvements followed on a daily board until they become standard, and the nerve to streamline a process that works but costs a step too many.
People and staffing	Recruitment and onboarding, one-to-one and appraisal conversations, competence matrix and cross-training plans, absence follow-up and vacation planning.
Systems	SAP ERP for orders, cost and asset data; time attendance, absence and overtime approval owned as a manager; Excel and Python for the follow-up that the standard reports do not show.
Safety	APV and risk assessment, LOTO, work permits and near-miss reporting in 24/7 operation; safety rounds and toolbox talks as part of the week.

EXPERIENCE

Owner / Technical Director — ELOHVAC ApS · Copenhagen · May 2023–present

Scope: 5 electricians and 3 apprentices · full P&L · electrical installation and service

- **People, staffing and delivery:** Recruitment, one-to-ones, training plans, absence follow-up and overtime approval for a team of eight; deliveries planned against customer deadlines and quality requirements, with documentation delivered with each job.

Senior Commissioning Engineer / Project Manager, Electrical Systems — Novo Nordisk A/S · Kalundborg/Bagsværd · Nov 2022–Jul 2024

Scope: 37 parallel capital projects · 25 specialists · 2–10 million DKK each · GMP/FDA/EMA

- **Regulated quality, planning and audit:** SOPs, change control, deviations and CAPA in a GMP system; IQ/OQ/PQ and FAT/SAT across 37 projects, handed over with zero critical findings; schedules broken into milestones and reported monthly in SAP.

Project and Workshop Manager — Ventek-Air · Copenhagen · Jan 2022–Nov 2022

Scope: 14 employees · 11 concurrent jobs · 2–10 million DKK per job

- **Prioritisation and daily direction:** Daily board meetings, capacity and bottleneck analysis across eleven concurrent jobs; priorities re-balanced the same day when a machine or a person was lost.

Operations and Maintenance Manager — Lynetten under Biofos · Copenhagen · Aug 2017–Jan 2022

Scope: Process plant in 24/7 shift operation · pumps, blowers, ventilation, transformers, switchgear and SCADA

- **Shift operation, 5S and KPIs:** 24/7 shift rota with absence cover and handover discipline; 5S, standard work and PDCA on workshop and stores; availability, breakdown and response time on the board, with over 40 % lower energy consumption documented.

Electromechanical Technician / Production Supervisor — ARJ Engineering · Tehran · Dec 2003–Mar 2010

Scope: 12 mechanics and technicians · machine workshop · industrial equipment

- **Shift planning and competence:** Shift planning, training and follow-up on output and quality targets for 12 technicians; root cause analysis and corrective action on production equipment.

EDUCATION AND AUTHORISATION

B.Tech degree, Technology Management & Mechanical Engineering · Maskinmesterskolen København · 2017–2022 · GPA 7.6/12

Authorised machine and electrical installer (LV/MV/HV) · Danish Safety Technology Authority · May 2023

Electrical and mechanical engineering · Tehran Technical University · 2000–2003 · EQF 6

Refrigeration, ventilation and safety training · STCW · Mercantec 2021 · Danish Maritime Authority 2021

LANGUAGES, PRACTICAL AND REFERENCES

Danish: native · English: fluent, written and spoken · Persian: native · Driver's licence B and car · Based in Måløv, Osted around forty-five minutes by car · Day shift, Monday to Friday, onsite · Available by agreement · SAP, Excel and Python daily · References on request.

WHAT THE ROLE ASKS FOR — MY EVIDENCE

Requirement	Evidence
5+ years of people management in production	Eight people with full P&L since 2023 — hiring, terminations, overtime approval and absence follow-up owned end to end; 14 employees and 11 concurrent jobs at Ventek-Air; 12 technicians in a machine workshop at ARJ; 25 specialists led across 37 capital projects at Novo Nordisk.
Medical device, pharma or life science production	Nearly two years inside a GMP/FDA/EMA system at Novo Nordisk: SOPs, deviations, CAPA, change control, IQ/OQ/PQ and audit, with zero critical findings across 37 projects — regulated manufacturing where the record is part of the product, and an auditor can ask for any part of it.
Managing employees in a production environment	Recruitment, one-to-ones, appraisal and development conversations, training and cross-training plans, absence follow-up, overtime approval and disciplinary conversations — held in skilled-trade teams where expectations are explicit.
Planning, prioritisation and reporting on daily operations	Daily boards and capacity planning across 11 concurrent jobs and a 24/7 shift rota; production plans broken into milestones and reported weekly and monthly to management and client.
KPIs and OEE	Availability, performance and quality measured from production, SCADA and asset data; output against plan, deviations and absence on one board — and the discipline to explain a number that moved for the wrong reason.
Lean Six Sigma and continuous improvement	5S, standard work, PDCA, A3, value stream mapping, Kaizen and root cause analysis applied daily; energy management on metering and SCADA data with over 40 % lower consumption documented.
QMS, GMP, GDP, NC, CAPA and a safe work environment	Deviations and NC raised and closed in a GMP system, CAPA verified for effect; 5S and visual standards owned on workshop and stores; APV, LOTO, work permits and near-miss reporting in live operation.
Staffing model, cross-training, vacation and absence	Staffing against an agreed model, competence matrix per machine group, vacation planned months ahead with the resource coordinators, and absence followed up individually and early.
Fluent English, SAP competence, collaboration	Fluent English in written and spoken reporting to management, auditors and clients; SAP in daily use and competence built in the team; cross-functional work with engineering, quality, supply chain and projects.

FIRST 90 DAYS — THE SHIFT, THE MATRIX AND THE BOARD	
Period	What happens, and how it is measured
Week 1–2	Walk the line on every machine group, at the machine and in the documentation. Read the shift handover, the deviation log, the absence figures and last quarter's output against plan. Sit with the coordinators and the Production Manager, and get the ProMark registrations and approvals caught up so nothing waits at period end.
Day 30	A one-page picture of the shift as it actually runs: staffing against the model, competence per machine group, where the handover loses information, the three absence drivers and the two machine groups that are hardest to cover.
Day 60	Cross-training plan agreed and started, with named people and dates; vacation plan for the next peak locked with the resource coordinators; board redesigned around output against plan, OEE components, quality and absence — readable in five minutes at handover.
Day 90	Team staffed and trained to the model with absence trending down; one improvement from the shift taken from idea to standard with production management; NC and CAPA closed within the agreed time; 5S and GMP standards visibly held — and every operator able to say what the shift is measured on.

QUALITY IS DECIDED AT THE MACHINE, NOT AT THE AUDIT

A medical device cannot be inspected into compliance. By the time quality assurance looks at a batch, the decisions have already been made — how the machine was set, whether the deviation was raised, whether the record was written while it was true. So the supervisor's work is to make the correct behaviour the cheapest one: equipment that is in calibration, instructions that can be followed in a gown, a deviation that is reported without punishment, and a shift that knows the difference between a small problem written down and a small problem hidden.

THE HANDOVER IS A QUALITY DOCUMENT

Most production losses I have seen were not made on a machine; they were inherited at a handover. A machine left in a doubtful state, a batch with a question mark, a training gap nobody mentioned. So the handover gets written the way a GMP record is written: what ran, what stopped, what was deviated, what the next shift must watch. Ten honest lines at the end of a shift save the next shift two hours of finding out.

ABSENCE IS A PLANNING PROBLEM BEFORE IT IS A PERSONNEL PROBLEM

A team that is short-staffed every Monday will have high absence, and no amount of reminders fixes it. The order is: staff to the model, cross-train so cover exists, plan holidays against the production plan, approve overtime with a reason, and then follow up individually with the people who are away — early, concretely, and with the same conversation for everyone. Most absence falls when the shift stops feeling like a place where being away is easier than being there.

TRAINING IS THE ONLY REAL FLEXIBILITY

Flexibility in a cleanroom does not come from asking people to do more; it comes from a competence matrix that shows, machine group by machine group, who is signed off, who is in training and where the single points of failure are. Then the training plan is written from the production plan: the next peak, the next holiday, the next new line. An operator signed off on three machine groups is worth more to the shift than any overtime budget, and the operator knows it.

IMPROVEMENT HAS TO END IN A STANDARD

Ideas from a shift are the cheapest improvement a factory has, and they die in the same way every time: nobody owns them, nothing is measured, and the next audit finds the old practice. So an idea gets an owner, a date and a number it should move; when it works it is written into the standard work and the training, and when it does not, we say so and stop. That discipline is also what makes a value like "own it" real on a shopfloor — the shift can point at the thing that changed because they raised it.

A SHIFT IS MANAGED IN THE FIRST HOUR

Most of what a shift becomes is decided before the machines are running: who is where, which line starts first, what the plan assumes, who is short, and what was left over from yesterday. So the first hour is where I spend my presence — walk the line, read the handover, agree the priorities with the coordinators and the Production Manager, and fix the staffing before the first stoppage instead of during it. After that the shift runs itself, and my job is to be visible, ask the second question, and take the decisions that need a leader rather than a meeting.